A JOURNEY THROUGH AMRITAVARSHAM

AVP PROJECT

TEAM MEMEBERS:

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Acknowledgement

We, the project team, would like to sincerely thank our AVP faculty coordinators and mentors for their constant guidance and support throughout this initiative. We are grateful to all our fellow students and staff who provided valuable feedback and encouragement, helping us to shape and complete the project successfully. Special thanks also go to the event organizers of Amma's birthday celebration for their cooperation and for providing us the opportunity to contribute meaningfully. The journey of creating this stall mapping website was a rich learning experience made possible by the collaborative spirit and kindness of everyone involved.

Our inspiration for this project is deeply rooted in Amma's teachings and her unwavering commitment to selfless service. Amma's message of compassion, community support, and helping others has been our guiding light, reinforcing the values of service-driven initiatives like this one. Through this project, we aimed not just to solve a practical challenge but also to embody the spirit of seva that Amma inspires, making a small positive difference for the visitors and devotees attending the event.

Introduction

One of the most significant occasions at Amrita is Amma's birthday celebrations, which attract thousands of devotees, visitors, and guests from around the world. During this large-scale event, numerous stalls are set up to provide services, food, and information to the attendees. However, with the sheer number of stalls and the unfamiliarity of visitors with the campus layout, many found it challenging to locate stalls efficiently.

Recognizing this challenge, our team proposed to create a digital solution in the form of a simple, user-friendly stall map website. The aim was to guide visitors by providing an accessible online platform where they could quickly identify the locations of stalls and navigate the event more easily.

This report details our process, challenges, solutions, and the impact of the project.

Objectives

The main goal of this project was to create a useful digital solution to improve the experience of visitors attending Amma's birthday celebrations at Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham. We aimed to develop an easy-to-use stall guidance website. This would help visitors navigate easily and save time.

The main objectives focused on providing help to the attendees:

- **To Facilitate Seamless Navigation**: Develop an easy-to-use digital platform that provides accurate and accessible information about stall locations.
- **To Reduce Confusion and Save Time**: Create a clear and user-friendly digital map to guide attendees, minimizing the difficulty of navigating a crowded event space.
- **To Assist Visitors in Locating Stalls Easily**: Provide a comprehensive stall mapping website that helps visitors quickly find specific points of interest.

This project aims to help team members build important skills like teamwork, problem-solving, and using technology in community service.

Methodology

The methodology for our project involved careful planning, on-ground data collection, and active interaction with the public to ensure that our solution was both useful and user-friendly.

1. Identifying the Problem

Realizing the large crowd expected at the Ashram and campus during Amma's birthday celebrations, we anticipated that visitors would face confusion in navigating the stalls. With people coming from outside, many unfamiliar with the layout, a simple physical map would not be sufficient. We identified the need for a digital guidance system that could be easily accessed on mobile devices.

2. Conceptualizing the Solution

To address this issue, we decided to create a website that displayed the stalls and their locations. Compared to physical maps, the digital platform provided several benefits, such as:

- Easy accessibility through smartphones.
- Ability to update information quickly if needed.
- Portable, as visitors could carry the map with them digitally.

3. Data Collection

From 25th morning to 26th noon, our team went stall by stall across the venue to gather accurate information. This included:

- Stall names and their purposes.
- Exact locations and placement within the event area.
- Key details that visitors might find useful.

This information was compiled and organized to be added into the website.

4. Website Development

Using Canva's site-building tools, we designed a simple, clean, and accessible website to display the stall information. We ensured that the site could easily be used on a mobile device, as most visitors would be using their phones to access it.

5. Testing Phase

Before releasing it to the public, we conducted a trial run with our batchmates. They were asked to navigate the site and provide feedback. This was to ensure that the site was user-friendly, functional, and easy to navigate.

6. Launch and Public Engagement

On 26th evening, we launched the project. QR codes linking to the website were generated and distributed to the visitors. Our method of approach was designed to build trust:

- We first introduced the project to visitors.
- To reassure them, we scanned the QR code ourselves on our devices and demonstrated the website.

- Once they saw the working site, we invited them to scan the QR code using their own phones.
- This strategy made people more comfortable in engaging with the project.

7. Challenges and Solutions

One of the main challenges faced was network connectivity. In some areas, visitors could not load the website immediately due to poor internet access. To overcome this, many took a photo of the QR code so they could try accessing it later when their connection improved. Despite this, the website was received positively as a practical tool.

Impact

Our project had a meaningful impact on the visitors as well as on us as a team:

Improved Visitor Experience

- The stall map website made it easier for visitors to locate stalls, saving time and reducing confusion during the large gathering.

Positive Engagement

- Visitors responded positively when we demonstrated the website on our own devices before inviting them to use it.

Supporting Value-Based Service

- By offering our skills in the form of a helpful tool, we practiced selfless service (seva).

Conclusion

The Stall Map Guidance Website Project was a valuable experience that combined technical skills, teamwork, and value-based service. By identifying a genuine challenge faced by visitors during Amma's birthday celebrations, we were able to design and implement a practical solution that made their experience smoother and more enjoyable. Through the use of a simple digital platform and QR codes, our project demonstrated how technology can be applied effectively for the benefit of society.

It was not just about creating a website but about understanding the needs of others and responding with compassion and creativity. By leveraging technology, our team was able to reduce confusion and improve accessibility for visitors, particularly those unfamiliar with the event layout.

In conclusion, the Stall Map Guidance Website was more than a technical exercise; it was a value-based learning journey that strengthened our skills, deepened our understanding of service, and brought us closer to the spirit of contributing positively to society.